Aston University
BIRMINGHAM UK

SCHOLARSHIP TERMS AND CONDITIONS

Postgraduate International Community Scholarship

Terms and conditions

January 2027 intake

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Purpose and scope

These Terms and Conditions govern the award of the Postgraduate International Community Scholarship (PG ICS) for eligible postgraduate taught applicants to Aston University.

The Scholarship is available to full-time, self-funded, overseas fee-paying students enrolling on eligible postgraduate taught programmes at Aston University's Birmingham campus for the **January 2027 intake only**.

> **AUTOMATIC AWARD — NO APPLICATION NEEDED**
>
> The PG ICS is an automatic scholarship subject to the conditions set out in these Terms and Conditions. There is no application process. Applicants who meet the published eligibility criteria and satisfy all conditions will receive the Scholarship, subject to successful enrolment.

These Terms and Conditions are correct at the time of publication but may be subject to change. The University reserves the right to amend, suspend, or withdraw the Scholarship where required for operational, regulatory, or strategic reasons.

Applicants classified as Home for tuition fee purposes are not eligible for the Postgraduate International Community Scholarship and should refer to the scholarships and funding information available to Home students, published on the Aston University website: **Home Fee Postgraduate Scholarships**.

Applicants classified as Overseas for tuition fee purposes should refer to the Aston University international scholarships pages for information on scholarships and discounts applicable to international students: **International Scholarships | Aston University**.

Definitions

For the purposes of these Terms and Conditions:

Enrolment

Completion of all registration, immigration, and attendance requirements as determined by Aston University, including confirmation of eligibility to study in the UK.

Overseas

A student classified by Aston University as an overseas student for tuition fee purposes in accordance with the University's fee status assessment and applicable UK legislation and regulations.

Self-funded

A student's tuition fees are paid entirely by the student and are not wholly or partially funded, reimbursed, or sponsored by any third party, employer, government, organisation, or external body.

Sponsored

A student's tuition fees are wholly or partially funded, reimbursed, or supported by a third party, including (but not limited to) an employer, government, organisation, or external body.

Postgraduate Taught (PGT)

A postgraduate programme delivered primarily through taught modules and assessment; excludes research-only or research-led programmes, including MRes programmes.

Programme deposit

The tuition fee deposit required to secure an offer of study, as specified in the applicant's offer letter.

Latest arrival date

The final date by which a student must enrol and commence attendance on their programme, as determined and communicated by Aston University.

Progression or articulation agreement

A formal agreement between Aston University and a partner institution that provides a defined route of entry to a postgraduate programme and may include separate scholarship, fee-discount, or partnership funding arrangements.

1 GENERAL PROVISIONS

1.1 To be eligible for the Postgraduate International Community Scholarship, applicants must be classified as Overseas for tuition fee purposes.

1.2 Applicants must hold an offer for a full-time postgraduate taught programme delivered on campus at Aston University, Birmingham, commencing in January 2027.

1.3 Applicants must be entering the first year of study of their postgraduate taught programme.

1.4 Applicants must meet all academic and non-academic conditions stated in their offer letter.

1.5 The Scholarship is available only to self-funded students. Applicants whose tuition fees are wholly or partially funded by a sponsor are not eligible, unless the sponsor has a formal written agreement with Aston University explicitly confirming eligibility for this Scholarship.

1.6 For the avoidance of doubt, any employer contribution, reimbursement, or third-party funding, whether paid directly to the University or reimbursed to the student, will be treated as sponsorship and renders the applicant ineligible.

1.7 Meeting the eligibility criteria does not create an unconditional entitlement to the Scholarship. The Scholarship is awarded only once all eligibility, offer conditions, deposit payment, and enrolment requirements have been satisfied.

1.8 Applicants acknowledge that they should not make financial, immigration, or personal decisions in reliance on the expectation of receiving the Scholarship until it has been formally applied following successful enrolment.

2 SCHOLARSHIP BASIS AND EXCLUSIONS

2.1 Scholarship basis

The Postgraduate International Community Scholarship is an automatic, non-competitive scholarship awarded to eligible applicants who meet the requirements set out in these Terms and Conditions.

2.2 Programme exclusions

The Scholarship applies to postgraduate taught (PGT) programmes only and does not apply to the following programmes:

- PGDip / MSc Overseas Pharmacy Assessment Programme (OSPAP)
- MSc Physician Associate Practice
- All MRes programmes
- All MBA programmes
- All Research programmes

Additional programme exclusions may apply where explicitly stated by the University.

2.3 Progression / articulation exclusions

Applicants are not eligible for the Postgraduate International Community Scholarship where they are progressing to a postgraduate taught programme at Aston University via a formal progression or articulation agreement for which Aston University operates a separate, dedicated scholarship, fee-discount, or partnership funding arrangement.

This includes, but is not limited to, applicants progressing via external or partner institutions where a specific progression award, guaranteed discount, or contractual fee arrangement applies.

Applicants progressing via articulation or progression routes without access to a separate Aston University partnership scholarship or fee-discount, including those entering directly into the first year of an eligible postgraduate taught programme, remain eligible, subject to meeting all other eligibility requirements set out in these Terms and Conditions.

Applicants who have completed, or are required to complete, pre-sessional or preparatory courses, including but not limited to pre-sessional English language programmes, study skills courses, or academic preparation modules, remain eligible, provided they are enrolling directly onto an eligible postgraduate taught programme and no separate progression or partnership scholarship applies.

3 SCHOLARSHIP TRIGGER, ACTIVATION, AND AWARD

3.1 Payment of the required programme deposit by the deadline stated in the offer letter is the trigger for consideration of the Scholarship.

3.2 The Scholarship becomes active only upon successful enrolment, which requires the applicant to have:

- met all conditions of their offer;
- paid the required programme deposit;
- successfully enrolled within the required enrolment period and latest arrival date; and
- received a Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS) and be holding a valid Student visa or another visa type that permits study.

3.3 The Scholarship is awarded as a **£4,000 tuition fee discount**, applied to the student's tuition fee account for the first year of study only, and does not create any expectation of continuation, renewal, or replacement funding in subsequent years.

The Scholarship value is determined by the University and may be amended, suspended, or withdrawn at the University's discretion. Where the University approves an elevated award value for selected programmes, this will be confirmed and published separately, and these Terms and Conditions will be updated accordingly.

3.4 The Scholarship will be applied to the student record by the University using its internal systems. Where a Scholarship has been applied in error, including due to administrative or system error, Aston University reserves the right to amend or withdraw the award. The application of a Scholarship in error does not create an entitlement.

3.5 The University shall not be liable where the award, activation, or continuation of the Scholarship is prevented, delayed, or restricted due to changes in law, government policy, regulatory requirements, sanctions regimes, or circumstances beyond the University's reasonable control.

3.6 Any discretion exercised in such cases does not create a precedent or entitlement for other applicants.

4 COMBINATION WITH OTHER SCHOLARSHIPS OR DISCOUNTS

4.1 A student may normally hold only one Aston University scholarship per programme of study.

4.2 Where a student is eligible for more than one scholarship or tuition fee discount, the highest-value award will usually apply.

4.2a Notwithstanding clause 4.2, the University reserves the right, at its sole discretion, to permit the Postgraduate International Community Scholarship to be held in combination with a separate, specifically designated scholarship or tuition fee award, where this is expressly approved and communicated by the University.

4.3 The Scholarship is not transferable to another applicant, programme, intake, academic year, or institution.

5 PROGRAMME CHANGES, WITHDRAWAL, AND RETENTION

5.1 Where a student changes programme during a permitted programme change period, eligibility for the Scholarship will be reassessed in line with these Terms and Conditions.

5.2 The Scholarship will continue to apply only where the new programme is eligible and is not listed as an excluded programme. Aston University reserves the right to withdraw the Scholarship where a student transfers to an excluded programme.

5.3 To retain the Scholarship, students must:

- remain fully enrolled and in attendance, as defined by Aston University;
- maintain Overseas fee status; and
- comply with all University regulations and applicable UK visa conditions.

5.4 Students who withdraw from Aston University part-way through an academic year will no longer be eligible for the Scholarship. Any tuition fee discount already applied may be withdrawn, and the student will be liable for the full tuition fee for that academic year.

5.5 Students repeating modules, whether with or without attendance, are not eligible to receive the Scholarship in respect of the repeated study.

5.6 Where a student suspends their studies and takes a Leave of Absence:

- if the Leave of Absence covers a complete academic year, no tuition fee is charged and no Scholarship is payable;
- if the Leave of Absence is taken part-way through an academic year, Scholarship eligibility will be assessed in line with Aston University's Tuition Fees Charging Policy and may be adjusted on a pro-rata basis.

6 DEFERRALS AND INTAKE VALIDITY

6.1 The Postgraduate International Community Scholarship is valid only for programmes commencing in the January 2027 intake.

6.2 The Scholarship cannot be deferred, carried forward, or transferred to a future intake.

6.3 Where an applicant defers their place, the Scholarship will be void.

7 APPEALS, FEEDBACK, AND FINAL DECISION

7.1 Decisions relating to eligibility and award of the Scholarship are made in accordance with these Terms and Conditions and internal University processes. The University's decision is final.

7.2 Appeals may be made only on the grounds of procedural error, defined strictly as a demonstrable failure by the University to follow these published Terms and Conditions.

7.3 Appeals will not be considered on the basis of:

- academic judgement;
- disagreement with eligibility outcomes;
- changes in personal or financial circumstances; or
- comparisons with other applicants or awards.

7.4 The University is not required to provide individual feedback on eligibility decisions, nor to disclose internal assessments, operational checks, or deliberative materials.

7.5 The University will not enter into further correspondence once the appeals process has concluded.

8 INTERPRETATION, PRECEDENCE, AND GOVERNING LAW

8.1 In the event of any inconsistency between these Terms and Conditions and any other University publication, webpage, correspondence, or third-party communication, these Terms and Conditions shall take precedence.

8.2 No representation made by an agent, representative, or third party shall be binding on the University unless confirmed in writing by the University.

8.3 These Terms and Conditions are governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of England and Wales, and the courts of England and Wales shall have exclusive jurisdiction.

TERMS AND CONDITIONS VALIDITY

January 2027 intake only

FURTHER INFORMATION AND ENQUIRIES

All enquiries relating to the Postgraduate International Community Scholarship should be directed to the Aston University International Office.

hello@aston.ac.uk